



GENDER PAY GAP

In theory, men and women should have equal bargaining power when competing for the same job. In practice, women often get significantly less pay, typically more than 20 percent less in the US. Laws have been introduced to lessen this gender pay gap, but it's still there. Various explanations have been given for this situation, but the most likely is the most obvious: sex discrimination.



TOP PAY

In the past, the highest paid people were professionals such as doctors and lawyers. The long training and level of skill involved meant that there were fewer of them. In recent years, professionals have been left behind by celebrities, business leaders, and people working in the financial industries—due to bonuses and commissions. In the UK in 2015, brokers earned on average \$184,000 annually. That compares with \$115,700 per year for senior doctors.

CEOs of the top 100 companies in the UK earn about 183 times more than a full-time worker on the average wage.



DIRTY WORK

Some people do dirty, unpleasant, and even dangerous work—often enduring long hours in bad conditions. Mostly, this is because they have no other choice, and in such cases the worst work is often the worst paid. In many developing countries, even children may be forced to work for dreadful pay in terrible conditions, making cheap goods in sweatshops and factories where there is little regard for their safety.